2020

Monitoring & Evaluation Policy

SOCIETY FOR NUTRITION EDUCATION AND HEALTH ACTION

Purpose

The Policy aims to explain the concept, functions, use, and implementation processes of Monitoring and Evaluation (M & E) in SNEHA. It also defines an operational framework, roles and responsibilities of all staff members. It contains principles and processes that support SNEHA in monitoring and evaluating programs in a timely, efficient and effective manner.

Definitions

Monitoring

Monitoring is the routine tracking of program activities by regularly measuring whether planned activities are being carried out. It informs program and project managers whether activities are being implemented according to plan, whether program's resources are used efficiently, whether interim targets are being met, and whether key performance measures are being achieved. Its purpose is to permit stakeholders to make informed decisions regarding the effectiveness of programs.

Evaluation

Evaluation is designed to determine the value of a specific program, intervention, or project in meeting stated objectives and outcomes. It is the evaluation of a program's processes, outcomes, or impacts to help understand how well the project has been implemented, has the desired change been achieved and if the change has been achieved, to what extent can it be attributed to the project.

(*A Guide for Monitoring and Evaluating Population-Health-Environment Programs, 2018. USAID, MEASURE Evaluation)*

Functions

In SNEHA, the M & E functions will entail to the following:

- To promote transparency and accountability in M & E of programs
- To support evidence-based decision making across programs
- To facilitate dissemination of evidence across different stakeholders

Principles

- M & E team has the functional authority and responsibility of carrying out M & E related work of SNEHA's maternal, child and adolescent health and nutrition programs.
- M & E team is responsible for formulation and application of processes and practices covering all M & E related work.

- M & E team will work closely with the programs to create and discuss evidence base with regard to implementation/steering decisions of the current program (modify or sustain intervention strategies) and contribute to the existing body of knowledge for future programs.
- M & E team will ensure that highest ethical standards is maintained in data collection, analysis and reporting of findings.
- M&E team will serve as an interface between program teams and decision-makers by shaping and moderating dialogue and strategic processes based on evidence generated.

Scope of work

- M & E team will take programs under its scope of work at the beginning of a new phase/program. Requests for management of M & E after the initiation of program implementation will be accommodated only in case of any unusual circumstances.
- M & E team will be responsible for current data management of programs that are under its purview. M & E team will not be responsible for management of data collected in previous years of program implementation when M & E of the programs was not under its purview.

Detailed scope of work of the M & E team will entail of the following:

- Assist the program team in drafting project proposal by providing supporting evidence for the suggested implementation models (literature review and analysis of data from previous phases/programs) and identifying relevant indicators pertaining to the stated program goal.
- Develop the M & E framework and plan for the program which will include evaluation design, monitoring formats and databases after the funding is secured.
- Facilitate program team in developing Logical Framework Analysis (LFA).
- Secure ethical approval for evaluation at the start of the program and get extension if required.
- Conduct baseline and endline evaluation and periodic surveys as per M & E plan and draft survey reports.
- Process the monitoring data for monthly/quarterly/yearly reports.
- Monthly monitoring meetings with the program teams to discuss the reports and jointly reexamine the pathways of change.
- Undertake sub-studies to address some of the questions that arise from the field experiences of the program. For new program, sub-studies will be undertaken after the program processes are stabilized (8-12 months of implementation). In order to maintain high standards of scientific quality, number of sub-studies will be limited to two for a three year project cycle.
- Conduct process evaluation for implementation of new models (if processes were not evaluated previously)

Process

Reports

- Reporting formats for monthly/quarterly reports will be finalized by M & E and program team within first three months of program implementation.

- Reporting formats will be revisited **every six months** and modification if any has to be communicated by program team through **email** to respective M & E PC and M & E APD.
- Data reports will be provided every month by M & E team in the said format in Tableau.
- Quarterly data reports for internal and external reviews will be provided by M & E team in Microsoft Powerpoint.
- Program team will be responsible for finalization of presentations to internal as well as external stakeholders.
- Data will be disseminated to internal and external stakeholders (funders, systems) by the program team.
- M & E data presentation/reports will be prepared in consultation with the program team.

Monitoring formats/database

- Monitoring formats/database will be developed as per the **program LFA and intervention protocol**. Management of any additional information/data collected will be the responsibility of the program team.
- Modification/addition in monitoring format/database if any will be made **every six months.**
- Based on the modification/addition required, program team has to send an **email** communication to respective M & E PC and M & E APD giving the following details:
    - ✓ Details of modification/addition
    - ✓ Reasons for modification/addition
- M & E team will make the changes as per the timelines stated in Table 1.

Data processing/analysis requisition

- Based on the information required, program/domain has to send an **email** communication to respective M & E PC and M & E APD giving the following details:
    - ✓ General description of the information required
    - ✓ Format of presentation (ex. tables, graphs, excel sheets)
    - ✓ Time period for the information requested
- M & E team will provide the data as per the timelines stated in Table 1.
- In case of any urgent request for data, program team is required to share the relevant emails from stakeholders with the M & E team.
- Responsibility in terms of usage of data remains with the program team. Repeated requests for the same will not be entertained.

Conflicts in data management

In case of any conflicts between program and M&E team on any aspect of data management, the program and M&E team will attempt to mutually resolve the conflict. If they are unable to come to a mutually acceptable solution, then the final decision in this regard will lie with the M & E team and the decision of the M&E Director and Associate Director will preside. This will allow for objectivity in data management in the organization.

Table 1 –Turnaround time for M&E and program team

Activities	**Timeline for M & E**	**Timeline for program team for feedback**
Literature review and supportive data analysis for program proposal	10 working days	-
Feedback on program proposal	5 working days after the draft shared by program team	-
Preparation of monitoring formats	10 working days	5 working days
Preparation of monitoring database in CommCare	10 working days	5 working days
Modification of database	5 working days	2 working days
Creation of Tableau dashboards	10 working days	5 working days
Modification of Tableau dashboards	5 working days	2 working days
Monthly Tableau dashboards	3 working days after syncing of data	2 working days
Quarterly reports	5 working days	5 working days
Annual reports	5 working days	5 working days
Half yearly/annual dashboards	2 weeks prior to review date	5 working days
Any subsequent iterations of information/reports	2 working days	-
Additional data analysis	5-15 working days based on type of analysis	-

This policy is applicable with effect from 1st October 2020.

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